

After 20 minutes of Bill and me talking between ourselves, Emma finally looked up from her phone.

‘Daddy, give me 50 bucks.’

‘Honey!’ he protested.

‘But I need to get . . . ’ she whined in a nasally voice.

Bill sighed and pulled out his wallet.

She swooped in and pecked a pineapple from his pouch.

(Clearly, she’d done this before.)

Emma flashed another half smile at me, mouthed ‘bye’ and then flew off.

Bill shifted uncomfortably in his seat.

‘I know I should be doing more with her, but you wait till you have kids! You have to pick your battles with teenagers! Besides, she’s actually a really smart kid . . . top of her class in physics last year . . .

‘She’ll work it out eventually . . . right?’

The Barefoot reunion

That meeting happened seven years ago.

I know the date, because I wrote a post about the meeting, and it’s still on my website today.

When I started writing this book about kids and money, I remembered Emma and wondered what had happened to her in those years. I actually had no idea—I hadn’t seen either of them since. So I called Bill and arranged a catch-up.

Think of this as the Barefoot ‘Where are they now?’ reunion special.

Emma the 16-year-old was now Emma the 23-year-old. She approached the table, with her sunnies on.

She sat down, smiled nervously and took off her aviators.